PRACTICE EXAM 22 / EXAM SET 04

Domain 1: Foundational Knowledge and Basic Science

15 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Health Care Systems and Settings

> **SCENARIO** A patient remains at home for a scheduled follow-up while the clinician remains at the clinic. They speak and see each other through a live, two-way video connection, with questions answered during the same encounter.

Which service format best describes this visit?

A. An asynchronous exchange of stored portal messages.
B. A home health visit with a clinician physically present in the residence.
C. A synchronous telehealth visit using real-time audio and video.
D. An in-person outpatient visit at a fixed clinic location.

Q02 | Basic Pharmacology

> **SCENARIO** An adult has a verified order for furosemide 60 mg orally once daily. The former solution contained 10 mg/mL, and an old worksheet listed 6 mL per dose. The pharmacy now supplies a solution containing 8 mg/mL and has confirmed that the prescribed milligram dose remains unchanged. A trained medical assistant is authorized to prepare the dose under applicable law and clinic policy.

What volume should the updated worksheet show for the current solution? Round to the nearest 0.1 mL.

A. 7.5 mL
B. 6 mL
C. 4.8 mL
D. 12 mL

Q03 | Medical Terminology

When combining gastr/o with -scopy and with -itis, which pair follows the usual combining-vowel rule?

A. Gastroscopy and gastroitis.
B. Gastroscopy and gastritis.
C. Gastrscopy and gastritis.
D. Gastrscopy and gastroitis.

Q04 | Psychology

> **SCENARIO** During a wellness visit, a 9-year-old proudly describes learning new school skills and keeping a record of tasks mastered through practice. The child is especially pleased when an adult recognizes the improvement.

In Erikson's framework, which developmental task is most directly reflected in this emphasis on mastering skills?

A. Developing basic trust in a dependable caregiver.
B. Developing ego integrity through acceptance of a life history.
C. Developing intimate partnerships during early adulthood.
D. Developing industry through a growing sense of competence.

Q05 | Basic Pharmacology

> **SCENARIO** A patient asks whether a single-ingredient acetaminophen pain reliever can be used with a differently branded nighttime pain product. The second product's Drug Facts label lists both acetaminophen and diphenhydramine. The clinician has not reviewed the proposed combination.

Which finding is most important to identify when flagging the combination for review?

A. The shared acetaminophen ingredient creates a risk of unintentional duplicate dosing.
B. The different brand names establish separate acetaminophen exposure limits for the two products.
C. The nonprescription status makes ingredient overlap less relevant than the product names.
D. Taking the products at different clock times removes concern about total acetaminophen intake.

Q06 | Health Care Systems and Settings

> **SCENARIO** A patient with hand arthritis has difficulty fastening clothing and using eating utensils. The clinician requests an evaluation of adaptive equipment and methods for performing these daily activities, rather than a new diet or a gait-training program.

Which professional has the most directly relevant expertise for this referral?

A. A registered dietitian.
B. A physical therapist.
C. An occupational therapist.
D. A respiratory therapist.

Q07 | Nutrition

SCENARIO A patient's existing nutrition plan calls for a snack with at least 10 g of protein and no more than 3 g of saturated fat. The patient brings four single-serving snack labels and plans to eat one full serving.

Which label meets both requirements of the supplied plan?

A. Protein 15 g; saturated fat 5 g.
B. Protein 12 g; saturated fat 2 g.
C. Protein 8 g; saturated fat 1 g.
D. Protein 6 g; saturated fat 4 g.

Q08 | Medical Terminology

SCENARIO A note describes a skin lesion on the dorsal surface of the left hand. Before showing the area to the provider, the assistant needs to distinguish this surface from the palm.

Which area does dorsal identify in this note?

A. The palm of the left hand.
B. The back of the left hand, opposite the palm.
C. The surface between the left thumb and index finger.
D. The back of the right hand, opposite its palm.

Q09 | Psychology

Which statement correctly distinguishes suppression from repression?

A. Suppression consciously sets aside a distressing thought; repression excludes it from awareness unconsciously.
B. Suppression excludes a thought unconsciously; repression consciously sets it aside for later consideration.
C. Suppression redirects emotion to another target; repression channels an impulse into a socially acceptable activity.
D. Suppression attributes a feeling to another person; repression supplies an acceptable justification for behavior.

Q10 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO Clinic policy requires medication-stock cabinets to be locked outside authorized access and their keys returned to a designated secure key locker after each use. A staff member locks a cabinet but leaves its key in an unlocked desk drawer nearby.

Which action completes the required storage-security process?

A. Leave the key in the drawer and label the drawer for staff use.
B. Hang the key behind the desk so it is out of direct patient view.
C. Put the key back in the cabinet lock so the next authorized staff member can find it.
D. Return the key to the designated secure key locker as the policy requires.

Q11 | Medical Terminology

SCENARIO A verified prescription says to take one capsule by mouth every other day. A draft instruction substitutes QOD. The clinic's documentation policy prohibits QD and QOD because they can be confused and requires the frequency to be written in full.

Which instruction preserves the verified frequency and follows the policy?

A. Take one capsule by mouth every other day.
B. Take one capsule by mouth once daily.
C. Take one capsule by mouth twice daily.
D. Take one capsule by mouth every other week.

Q12 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO A clinician's plan includes topical hydrocortisone cream for a small skin rash and a transdermal nicotine patch for smoking cessation. A patient asks why two products applied to skin can have different intended treatment targets.

Which explanation best distinguishes their intended delivery?

A. Both are intended primarily for local skin effects; the dosage-form names mainly describe packaging.
B. The cream is intended primarily for a local skin effect, while the patch delivers medicine through skin for systemic action.
C. The cream is intended for systemic delivery, while the patch is intended to act at its application site.
D. The intended effect depends primarily on the amount placed on skin rather than the formulation and delivery system.

Q13 | Health Care Systems and Settings

SCENARIO A nationally certified medical assistant moves to a clinic in another state and is asked to perform a task not previously included in the assistant's duties. The clinic's onboarding policy requires review of applicable state permissions, any required governmental credential, task training, and supervision before a new task is assigned. The assistant believes national certification makes that review unnecessary.

Which conclusion best addresses this belief about certification and legal practice authority?

A. Permission for the task in the former workplace establishes permission in the new state.
B. A clinician's request makes the national certificate sufficient without reviewing the task requirements.
C. A national examination makes authorized duties identical wherever the credential is recognized.
D. Certification recognizes qualifications; permission for the new task still requires the specified legal, training, and supervision review.

Q14 | Nutrition

SCENARIO During a dietary history, a patient reports following a vegan diet with no animal-derived foods, no vitamin B12-fortified foods, and no supplements. The patient regularly eats fruits, vegetables, beans, and whole grains and asks whether this pattern supplies every needed vitamin.

Which nutrient-source concern is most appropriate to bring to the clinician or dietitian?

A. Vitamin C may require an animal-derived source despite the regular fruit and vegetable intake.

B. Vitamin B12 needs a reliable source, such as fortified foods or supplementation reviewed with the care team.

C. Dietary fiber may require a supplement because beans and whole grains do not provide it.

D. Vitamin K cannot be obtained from plant foods and therefore requires an animal-derived source.

Q15 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO An authorized, trained medical assistant gives a correctly ordered oral medication at 10:20 a.m. but accidentally records the administration time as 10:02 a.m. Clinic policy requires dated and timed corrections that retain the original entry and audit trail. No second dose was given.

Which action best fulfills the right of accurate medication documentation?

A. Make a dated and timed correction identifying 10:20 a.m. as the actual administration time while preserving the original entry.

B. Delete the original administration entry and replace it without retaining a correction history.

C. Leave the recorded time unchanged and tell the next assistant about the error verbally.

D. Enter a second administration at 10:20 a.m. so that one of the two entries has the correct time.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

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01 C	02 A	03 B	04 D	05 A	06 C
07 B	08 B	09 A	10 D	11 A	12 B
13 D	14 B	15 A			

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: C

A synchronous telehealth visit using real-time audio and video.

Synchronous telehealth involves real-time interaction between participants in different locations. A portal message reviewed later is asynchronous, and neither a home visit nor an in-person clinic visit matches the locations described.

Q02 | Correct answer: A

7.5 mL

Use the current concentration: 60 mg / 8 mg/mL = 7.5 mL. Reusing the old 6 mL volume would provide 48 mg from the new solution, rather than the ordered 60 mg. A concentration change requires recalculating volume even when the prescribed milligram dose stays the same.

Q03 | Correct answer: B

Gastroscopy and gastritis.

The combining vowel is retained before the consonant-starting suffix -scopy, producing gastroscopy. It is usually dropped before a vowel-starting suffix such as -itis, producing gastritis.

Q04 | Correct answer: D

Developing industry through a growing sense of competence.

Industry versus inferiority is associated with developing competence through learning, practice, and accomplishment during the school-age years. The child's focus on mastering tasks fits industry, rather than the infancy, early-adult, or later-adult tasks in the other choices.

Q05 | Correct answer: A

The shared acetaminophen ingredient creates a risk of unintentional duplicate dosing.

Both products supply acetaminophen, so using them together can unintentionally increase total exposure and the risk of harm. Active ingredients, not brand names or marketing categories, determine this duplication; the patient needs clinician or pharmacist review before adding the second product.

Q06 | Correct answer: C

An occupational therapist.

Occupational therapists help people perform daily activities and can recommend adaptive equipment for tasks such as dressing and eating. A physical therapist may address movement and mobility, but adapting the specified daily tasks is the central referral need.

Q07 | Correct answer: B

Protein 12 g; saturated fat 2 g.

The snack with 12 g of protein and 2 g of saturated fat meets both the minimum protein amount and maximum saturated-fat amount. The 15 g protein snack exceeds the fat limit; the other two snacks do not reach the protein minimum.

Q08 | Correct answer: B

The back of the left hand, opposite the palm.

The dorsal surface of the hand is its back, opposite the palmar surface. The left-hand laterality remains unchanged; dorsal does not identify the web space between the thumb and index finger.

Q09 | Correct answer: A

Suppression consciously sets aside a distressing thought; repression excludes it from awareness unconsciously.

Suppression is a conscious decision to set a distressing thought aside, often to address it later. Repression involves unconscious exclusion from awareness; the other descriptions confuse these concepts with different defense mechanisms.

Q10 | Correct answer: D

Return the key to the designated secure key locker as the policy requires.

Locking the stock cabinet is only one part of the supplied policy; its key must also be secured in the designated location. A key left in an unlocked drawer, on a hook, or in the lock can undermine access control, even if it is not immediately visible.

Q11 | Correct answer: A

Take one capsule by mouth every other day.

Writing every other day in full retains the verified schedule and avoids the prohibited abbreviation. Once daily would increase dosing frequency, while twice daily and every other week would also change the prescribed regimen.

Q12 | Correct answer: B

The cream is intended primarily for a local skin effect, while the patch delivers medicine through skin for systemic action.

A transdermal nicotine patch is designed to deliver medicine across the skin for systemic effects, whereas the hydrocortisone cream in this plan targets local skin inflammation. Local intent does not mean that systemic absorption of a topical product is impossible; the distinction concerns the formulation's intended delivery and effect.

Q13 | Correct answer: D

Certification recognizes qualifications; permission for the new task still requires the specified legal, training, and supervision review.

National certification recognizes qualifications but does not by itself establish identical legal authority for every task in every jurisdiction. The supplied policy requires a separate review before assigning the new task, including any license or other governmental credential required for that role and location.

Q14 | Correct answer: B

Vitamin B12 needs a reliable source, such as fortified foods or supplementation reviewed with the care team.

Vitamin B12 is naturally found primarily in animal-derived foods, and reliable fortified foods or supplements are important sources for people who exclude those foods. The reported absence of both fortified sources and supplementation warrants review; the assistant should not diagnose deficiency or independently prescribe a supplement dose.

Q15 | Correct answer: A

Make a dated and timed correction identifying 10:20 a.m. as the actual administration time while preserving the original entry.

Accurate medication documentation should reflect the actual administration, and the supplied policy requires a traceable correction. Adding another administration would falsely imply a second dose, while deleting the history or relying only on a verbal explanation would not provide the required accurate, auditable record.

End of Practice Exam